

SAMANTHA CERVANTES

Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs, Syracuse University

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(858) 205-9998

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Public Administration

2022 –

Syracuse University, Maxwell School

Fields: Urban Economics and Economics of Education

Advisors: Michah W. Rothbart and Amy E. Schwartz

M.S., Applied Economics with Honors

2022

Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM), Mexico City, Mexico

B.A., Business Administration, minor in Political Science

2018

Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM), Mexico City, Mexico

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Policy Analysis, Neighborhood Effects, Economics of Crime, Economics of Education

RESEARCH

Working Papers

Too Bright to Learn: Causal Impacts of Crime-Reduction Lighting on Student Outcomes

Cervantes, S., & Schwartz, A. E. [Job Market Paper]

Hold Harmless for Whom? The Impact of COVID Era Policies for School Funding, Teachers, and Students.

Rothbart, M. W., Cervantes, S., & Schwartz, A. E. (R&R at *Education Finance and Policy*)

How a Good School in the Neighborhood Affects Academic Outcomes

Cordes, S., Han, J., Schwartz, A. E., & Cervantes, S.

Works in Progress

The Long-Term Impact of Neighborhood Violence on Youth Outcomes

Cervantes, S., & Schwartz, A. E.

The Impact of a Crime Deterrence Intervention on Political Behavior

Cervantes, S., & Shi, Y.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Associate

2022 –

Center for Policy Research, Syracuse University

Professors Michah W. Rothbart and Amy E. Schwartz

Research Assistant

2019 – 2022

Center for Competitiveness Studies (CEC), Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM)

Professor Guillermo Abdel Musik

TEACHING

Syracuse University (Master's courses)

Quantitative Analysis (Graduate Teaching Assistant)	Spring 2024, Spring 2025
Public Budgeting (Graduate Teaching Assistant)	Fall 2022, Summer 2023, Summer 2024
Education Policy (Guest Lecturer)	Spring 2025
Quantitative Analysis (Guest Lecturer)	Spring 2025

PRESENTATIONS

2026: American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association; FLX Economics of Education Workshop; Capital District Applied Microeconomics Workshop; Association for Education Finance and Policy
2025: Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management
2024: Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management; Association for Education Finance and Policy; Public Finance and Budgeting Northeastern Workshop
2023: Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management

GRANTS & AWARDS

First Place, Graduate Student Poster Session Center for Policy Research, Syracuse University	2026
Summer Dissertation Fellowship (\$4,500) Syracuse University	
PhD Department Research Grant (\$4,000) Syracuse University	2025
Financial Inclusion Essay Award National Banking and Securities Commission	2021

OTHER EDUCATION AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Certificate in Applied Statistics Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM), Mexico City, Mexico	2018 – 2019
Investment Consultant Profuturo Pensiones, Mexico City, Mexico	2018 – 2019
B.A., Sociology, Open University System Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México (UNAM), Mexico City, Mexico	2016 – 2021

SERVICE

Graduate Student Representative Center for Policy Research, Syracuse University	2026-2027
Educational Researcher, reviewer	

SKILLS

Statistical software: Stata, R, QGIS (advanced), Python (intermediate)

Last updated: May 24, 2026